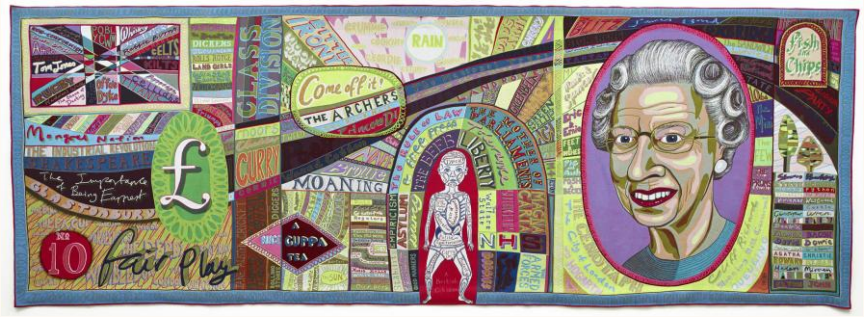
WORKSHEET · ExplENGLISH

Grayson Perry's Comfort Blanket

A Portrait of Modern Britain



Name: **Class:**

Date:

1. Warm-up / Instap (± 10 min)

Goal: activate prior knowledge and introduce the topic.

. On your Post-it note, draw or write the first things you think of when you hear the word "British" — people, food, places, objects, anything!

Stick your Post-it in the box below, or draw your ideas straight into it.

2. Reading

Reading for gist (2 minutes)

Skim the text quickly — don't stop for new words. Then circle the best summary.

A. The tapestry shows that the Queen is the most important symbol of Britain.

B. The tapestry celebrates modern Britain as a diverse country where everyone belongs.

C. The tapestry criticises British people for being too traditional.

Grayson Perry's Comfort Blanket – A Portrait of Modern Britain

Grayson Perry is one of Britain's best-known artists, who is famous for creating colourful and thought-provoking works of art. In 2014, he created a large tapestry called Comfort Blanket, which was shown at the National Portrait Gallery in London. The exhibition, which focused on identity, invited visitors to think about what it means to be British. Perry wanted the tapestry to show modern Britain and the people who live there.

The tapestry is based on the design of a British £10 note, which many people recognise. In the middle is a picture of Queen Elizabeth II, who does not look formal or distant. Instead, Perry wanted her to look more like a kind aunt than a powerful queen. This makes the artwork feel warm, friendly, and familiar instead of official.

The artwork is full of words, pictures, and symbols that represent everyday British life. Some of them are traditional, such as cricket, village greens, gardens, pubs, and the countryside. Others show modern Britain, which is a country with many cultures, languages, and traditions. Perry believes Britain is a diverse nation whose strength comes from its different communities. He celebrates the people who have different backgrounds and experiences.

The tapestry also shows that British identity is connected to social class, which has always been important in Britain. Perry includes words that remind people of different lifestyles. For example, "Eton", "Aga", and "green wellies" represent wealth and the upper middle class. Other words, such as "boozer", "Blackpool", and "allotments", are linked to working-class life. By putting these images together, Perry shows that every group that lives in Britain is part of the country's identity.

Perry does not want people to take nationalism too seriously. He includes the phrase "Come off it!", which is a common British expression meaning "Don't be silly!" or "I don't believe you." This reminds people who see the tapestry to question ideas instead of accepting them without thinking. Perry believes that the ability to laugh at ourselves is an important British quality.

The title Comfort Blanket, which may sound unusual at first, has a special meaning. Perry got the idea from a friend whose family escaped from Hungary as refugees in 1956. When they arrived in Britain, they finally felt safe. His friend's mother later called Britain her "security blanket", which inspired the title of the artwork. Perry hopes the tapestry will remind people that Britain should be a place where everyone feels welcome and protected. He even said he would like it to hang in a citizenship centre, where new British citizens could see it after passing their citizenship test.

In the end, Comfort Blanket is more than a beautiful piece of art. It is a celebration of modern Britain, which is made up of many different cultures, traditions, and histories. Perry shows that there is no single way to be British. Instead, British identity belongs to everyone who lives in the country and helps to shape its future.

Reading for detail

Read the text again carefully. Answer the questions in short sentences.

1. What is Grayson Perry famous for?

2. What is the tapestry's design based on?

3. Give one traditional and one modern example of British life shown in the tapestry.

4. Name two words in the tapestry that represent wealth, and two that represent working-class life.

5. What does the phrase "Come off it!" mean, and why does Perry include it?

6. Where does the title Comfort Blanket come from?

7. Where does Perry hope the tapestry could hang one day, and why?

3. Grammar: Relative Pronouns

Read the text again. Underline all examples of who, which, and that.

3.1 What do you notice?

3.2 Complete the rules

Why do we use relative pronouns?

When do we use which pronoun?

We use **who** for

We use **which** for

We use **that** for

3.3 Circle the correct relative pronoun, explain why.

1. Grayson Perry, (who / which / that) created the tapestry, is a famous British artist.

Why :

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2. The tapestry, (who / which / that) is shaped like a £10 note, hangs in a gallery.

Why :

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3. Perry included the phrase "Come off it!", (who / which / that) many British people use every day.

Why :

4. The Queen, (who / which / that) appears in the middle of the tapestry, looks kind and friendly.

Why :

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5. Britain is a country (who / which / that) has many different cultures and traditions.

Why :

3.4 Join the Sentences

Combine each pair of sentences using **who**, **which** or **that**.

Example

Grayson Perry is an artist. He created *Comfort Blanket*.

Grayson Perry is an artist **who created *Comfort Blanket*.**

1. *Comfort Blanket* is a large textile artwork. It represents British identity.

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2. Perry included Queen Elizabeth II. She is an important British figure.

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3. The collage contains many symbols. They represent different communities.

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4. Some British people have multicultural backgrounds. They may not identify with traditional symbols.

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5. The students created collages. The collages show different ideas about national identity.

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6. A museum curator is a person. This person selects artworks for an exhibition.

3.5 Correct or Rewrite

Each sentence contains a mistake. Rewrite it correctly.

1. Grayson Perry is an artist which creates colourful artworks.

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2. The symbols who appear in the collage represent Britain.

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3. The Queen is a person which is recognised around the world.

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4. The images who Perry selected show different parts of British society.

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5. A museum is a place who displays artworks.

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6. People which visit the exhibition may have different opinions.

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4. Create Your Own Collage

Your task

Create a collage that represents your country's national identity.

Think about:

- ☐ traditions
- ☐ history
- ☐ famous places
- ☐ food
- ☐ sports
- ☐ culture
- ☐ diversity
- ☐ modern life
- ☐ important people
- ☐ values

Use old magazines, colours, drawings, photos — anything you like!

MY COLLAGE

5. Museum Label

Write a museum label for your collage (100–150 words).

Your label should:

✓ explain your collage

✓ describe your symbols

✓ explain your message

✓ use at least three relative clauses (who, which, that)

6. Exit Ticket – Museum Curator

Congratulations! You are now a curator.

The museum only has space for four artworks in the exhibition National Identity. Which four collages would you choose?

1.

2.

3.

4.

Choose ONE artwork. Explain why it deserves a place in the exhibition.

Use at least one relative pronoun (who, which, or that).